From Claude to Tax

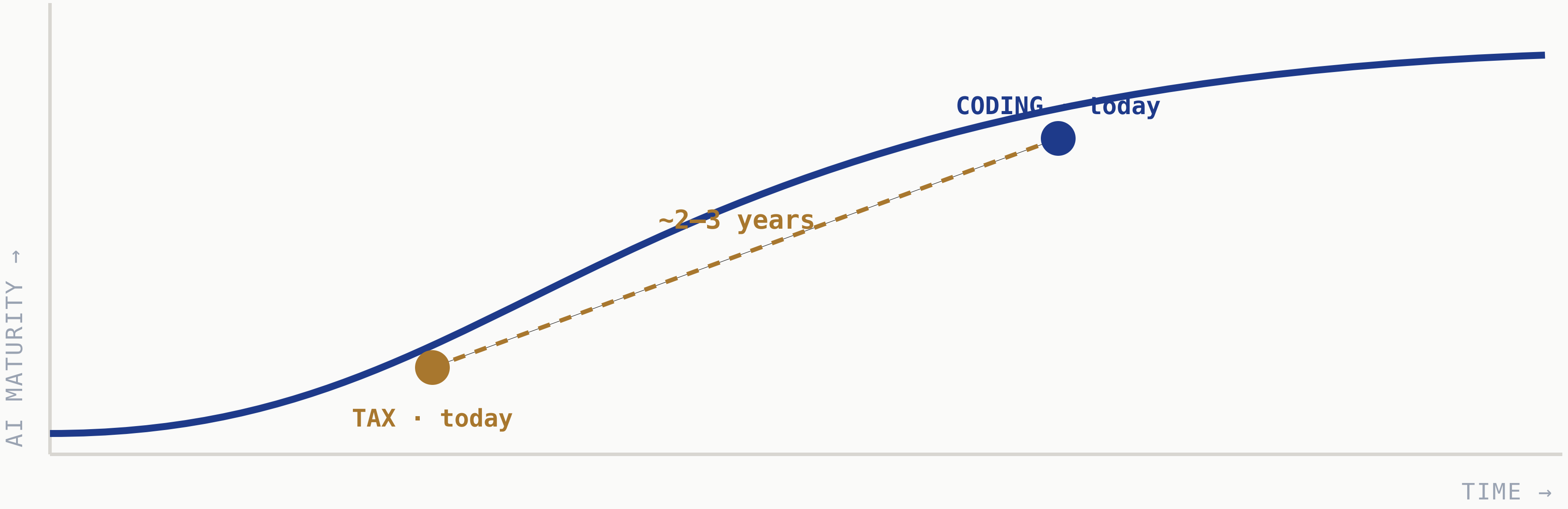
How AI evolves in three stages — what we can already see in software, and what we're building at Meta to bring it to tax.

A practical look at the infrastructure that makes it real.

START WITH WHAT WE CAN SEE

Coding is the leading indicator

Claude Code made AI-native development the default. Coding is where AI hit first — so it's the map for what's coming next, including tax.



Same curve, a few years apart — **watch coding and you can read tax's map ahead.**

THE PATTERN

AI evolves in three stages — climbed in order

01

AI-Native Foundation

AI & data built in, not bolted on. Copilots assist; humans own.

02

Continuous Learning

Learns from feedback & outcomes, and adapts on its own. Accuracy compounds.

03

Proactive Management

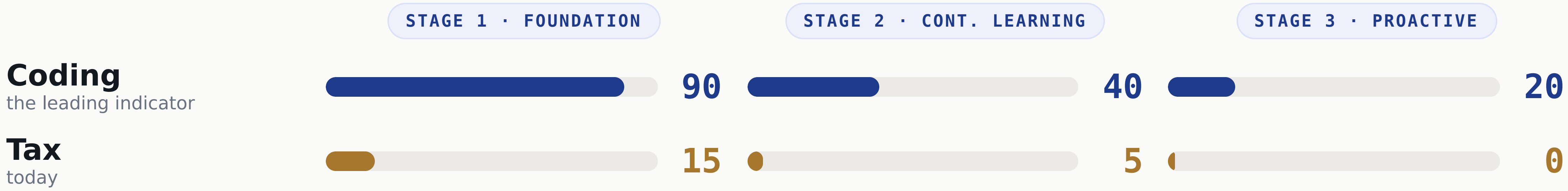
Acts *before* you ask. Near-autonomous — but a human still approves.

↑ EACH STEP NEEDS THE ONE BELOW

You can't skip a step. The order isn't optional.

WHERE CODING STANDS

Score the three stages, 0–100



Coding has finished Stage 1 and is mid-Stage 2. Tax is at the very start — **same curve, ~2–3 years apart.**

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR TAX

Coding figures it out first — then it diffuses

THE FRONTIER

Coding

Most investment, most talent — the harness gets invented here first.

DIFFUSES →

- **Tax** adopts the proven harness as it arrives
- **Finance & Legal** next in line
- **Other verticals** follow the same path

The harness for Stage 2 & 3 doesn't fully exist yet — anywhere. **We don't need to invent it. We need to be ready when it arrives.**

OUR PLAY AT META

So we start at Stage 1 — across the whole tax lifecycle

We're building **one** AI-native foundation — and every stage of the tax lifecycle draws from it.

Tax Planning

Scenario modeling & structuring, grounded in our positions and the law.

Compliance & Reporting

High-volume, rules-based work on real-time data — the natural first mover.

Tax Audit

Controversy & defense on the same lineage, sources, and document trail.

1 **One AI-Native Foundation** shared data · grounding · governance — under all three

Foundation first. Build it once, build it well.

WHY FOUNDATION-FIRST PAYS OFF

Connect end-to-end — a flywheel kicks in

Connect Planning → Compliance → Audit on one foundation and each loop compounds — **audit closes the loop.**

1 · Connect end-to-end
Planning → Compliance → Audit on one foundation

2 · Audit-ready lineage
Every number traces to source — defensible on demand

3 · Feedback captured
Audit outcomes & corrections become learning signal

4 · Foundation compounds
Cleaner data → better planning & compliance → more to connect

↻ FLYWHEEL
audit closes the loop

Each turn makes the data cleaner and the foundation smarter — **the exact feedback engine Stage 2 will run on.**

UNDER THE HOOD — IN PLAIN TERMS

The "AI" is just the models. The rest is the work.

Most of this isn't the model at all — it's skills, connectivity, knowledge and controls. Here's the stack without the jargon:

LAYER	WHAT IT DOES	EXAMPLES · META
Experience	Where teams ask questions & review answers	apps · copilots **Meta: React**
AI skills	The tasks AI can do — prep a return, draft a memo, reconcile	Claude Skills · agents **Meta: internal skills**
Skill management	Approve, version & control which skills run — and who may use them	registry · guardrails **Meta: governance**
MCP / connectors	The universal adapter so AI can reach your systems	MCP · ERP/tax-engine links **Meta: tool gateway**
Models (the AI)	The reasoning engine — a swappable commodity	Claude · GPT · Gemini **Meta: Llama**
Knowledge	Your tax law, rates & positions — grounded and cited	search / RAG **Meta: FAISS**
Relationships (graph)	Entity ↔ jurisdiction ↔ product · ownership chains	Neo4j · Neptune **Meta: TAO**
Data foundation	Clean, real-time tax data	Snowflake · Databricks **Meta: data platform**
Trust & controls	Security, privacy, audit trail, accuracy checks	Immuta · OneTrust **Meta: privacy infra**

The moat isn't the model — it's running **every layer, together.**

MAKE IT CONCRETE

Why the model alone isn't enough

“Did we charge the right sales tax on this $2M order shipped to Texas?”

The model alone

Knows Texas sales tax *in general*. But not **your** order, your nexus, today's rate — or how to prove it.

With the foundation, it can…

`Data platform`	pull the real order — $2M, ship-to TX, the product SKU
`Graph`	which legal entity sold it · TX state→county→city · is the product taxable
`Knowledge`	today's Texas rule & rate — **with a citation**
`Models`	reason over all of it to an answer
`Trust & controls`	check who may see it · log every step
`Eval + lineage`	confidence check; unsure → human · every number traces back

The model is one slice of the answer. The **infrastructure is the rest** — and the part that holds up in an audit.

THE HONEST PART

Hard for most — but we have a head start

Why it's hard

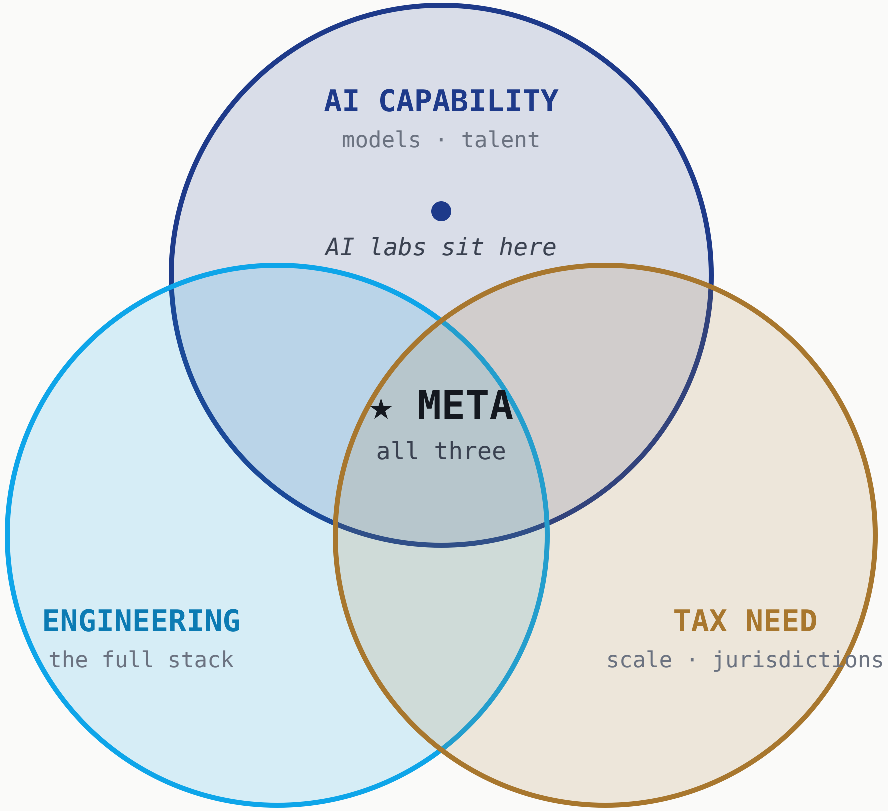
- Fragmented, messy data across ERPs & jurisdictions
- Real-time / streaming is a specialized skill set
- Talent fluent in tax *and* AI is doubly rare
- Split ownership: Tax vs. Finance Systems vs. IT
- Tax is a cost center — hard to fund infra

Why Meta is positioned

- Hyperscale data infrastructure already exists
- Real-time / event-driven by default
- World-class platform, data & ML engineers
- AI platform & compute in-house, not procured
- Engineering-owned tax tech — ships like a product team

The barriers most teams hit are largely **already solved here** — so we get to start where others can't.

The transformation takes all three at once



Why not the frontier labs?

- They're building the **ecosystem** — models, skills, MCP — and want you on their platform.
- But their **vertical** AI investment is coding-deep; for tax it's still surface-level.
- Lighter broad-engineering footprint, and an early tax footprint — one is just standing up a tax engine.

The horizontal AI is theirs to sell. The **vertical tax foundation is yours to own** — and it takes all three circles.

THE TAKEAWAY

Build the foundation now. Be ready when the harness arrives.

Coding shows the path. The three stages are real. The winning move in tax is Stage 1 — done well, across the lifecycle.

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